

AY25 PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2026.1

Tracking Data

CIM code (e.g., ME-CM)	MS-ARCT
Program Name	Master of Science in Architecture
Assessment Year	2025
Program Assessment Coordinator	Vedran Mimica
Year of Current Assessment Plan	2025
No Assessment This Year per Plan	☐
LO(s) Assessed	LO 2 - Student will be able to appropriately apply theoretical, sociological, ecological and technological aspects in relationship to urban domains.
Presented at program authority meeting date: <i>Please attach minutes</i>	10/08/2025

Methodology

For **LO2** final student projects were selected as assessment artifacts.

Six representative student works were chosen that explicitly address urban contexts through research, design, and analysis. Each artifact demonstrates the student's ability to apply multidisciplinary frameworks to contemporary urban issues, making them directly concordant with LO2.

The artifacts were evaluated using a **five-criterion rubric**:

1. Theoretical Integration
2. Sociological Awareness
3. Ecological/Environmental Awareness
4. Technological/Design Application
5. Urban Contextualization

Each criterion was scored holistically across three categories:

- **D (Does not meet expectations)**
- **M (Meets expectations)**
- **P (Proficient)**

Criterion	Does Not Meet (D)	Meets (M)	Proficient (P)
1. Theoretical Integration	Weak or absent use of theory	Applies theory adequately	Sophisticated and original theoretical framework
2. Sociological Awareness	Ignores or misrepresents social dynamics	Recognizes and integrates social concerns	Deep, nuanced integration of social equity & inclusion
3. Ecological/Environmental Awareness	Limited or absent ecological awareness	Demonstrates adequate ecological consideration	Strong, innovative ecological integration with urban systems
4. Technological/Design Application	Weak or generic design solutions	Functional use of technology/design	Innovative application of design/tech in urban context
5. Urban Contextualization	Fails to connect to urban domain	Connects ideas to urban issues	Strongly contextualized, engages critically with urban systems

Results

Artifact samples

Submitted as supplement files.

Data table

Student	Theoretical	Sociological	Ecological	Technological	Urban Context	Overall Category
Artifact 1 – <i>Breaking Barriers</i>	P	P	M	M	P	P
Artifact 2 – <i>Reconditioning Dharavi</i>	P	P	M	M	P	P
Artifact 3 – <i>Interweaving City</i>	P	P	M	M	P	P
Artifact 4 – <i>Play Space Metropolis</i>	M	P	M	M	P	M
Artifact 5 – <i>Guidebook to Kerala</i>	M	M	P	M	M	M
Artifact 6 – <i>Green Prescription</i>	P	M	P	M	P	P

Description of findings

Assessment results show that **83% of students (5 of 6)** demonstrated proficiency (P), while **17% (1 of 6)** met expectations (M). No student fell into the “Does Not Meet” (D) category.

Key strengths identified include:

- **Theoretical grounding:** Most students engaged deeply with urban theory and demonstrated the ability to connect conceptual frameworks to their design proposals.
- **Sociological integration:** Students consistently addressed issues of equity, inclusion, and community, showing strong awareness of how architecture intersects with social structures.
- **Urban contextualization:** All projects demonstrated a clear engagement with the complexities of urban systems, including informal settlements, mixed-income housing, tourism infrastructure, and public health.

Areas for growth include:

- **Ecological and technological integration:** While many projects showed awareness of environmental and technological considerations, these aspects were less consistently developed than the theoretical and sociological components. In some cases, sustainability strategies or technical innovations were included but not fully embedded in the design logic.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

The purpose of assessment is to improve the quality of our educational programs. The most important part of the assessment cycle is how we use the data to improve our programs. Examine the data provided above describing student achievement, consider the root cause of any deficits, and if areas for possible improvement emerge, describe plans to achieve this improvement.

Root Causes Identified

- While ecological frameworks are consistently emphasized in teaching, the specific topics students choose to investigate may not always require extensive ecological or technological engagement. As a result, these dimensions are not equally foregrounded across all projects.
- Technological integration is often introduced through electives or specialized modules, which may not directly align with the core themes of individual student projects. This creates variability in the depth of technological application, depending on a student’s selected focus.

- Students who demonstrate strong proficiency in theoretical and sociological aspects may have limited exposure to advanced environmental systems or digital/technological tools within the context of their project development.
- Feedback on ecological and technological integration often occurs later in the design process (e.g., at midterm or final reviews). In such cases, opportunities for substantive revisions are limited, and some projects may not fully integrate these elements if their primary emphasis lies on other critical social or theoretical concerns.

Plans to Achieve Improvement

The program will address the uneven integration of ecological and technological elements while maintaining the student's freedom to define their own topics and research pathways, a hallmark of the Master of Science program. Rather than mandating these elements for every project, the goal is to expand opportunities, resources, and checkpoints so that students who wish to engage with ecological or technological aspects can do so more effectively.

1. Expanded Exposure Across the Curriculum
 - Ensure that core seminars and design studios provide case studies and methods highlighting ecological and technological approaches, regardless of the project theme. This ensures all students are familiar with these tools, even if they ultimately pursue other directions.
2. Resource Enrichment and Interdisciplinary Support
 - Strengthen cross-department collaborations to provide consultation opportunities for students who want to embed these elements more deeply in their research.
 - Develop a library of exemplar projects where ecological and technological integration has been successfully incorporated, giving students reference points without prescribing outcomes.
3. Faculty Feedback Practices
 - Encourage faculty to raise ecological and technological questions earlier in reviews, not as mandatory requirements but as potential dimensions students may consider.
 - This ensures students understand the value of these approaches while retaining autonomy over their research trajectory

Prior CI plan impact

Also, please refer to the previous assessment report for the LOs assessed. Were any CI plans recommended? Were they implemented? Did the plans work (were improvements seen in this cycle)?

☐ no previous CI plans available

This cycle's CI plan

- Embed case studies and methods related to ecological design and urban tech in the M.S.Arch research studio.
- Formalize partnerships with departments such as Engineering, Computer Science and AI.
- Create a digital library of past student projects with exemplary ecological and technological integration. Updated annually, accessible to all enrolled students.
- Encourage students to consider ecological and technological aspects earlier, even if not central to their project.

Timeline:

Spring 2026

- Develop exemplar project library
- Initiate cross-department collaborations

Fall 2026

- Integrate ecological/tech case studies into M.S.Arch studio.
- Implement early feedback encouraging ecological and technological in the desired topic.

These plans will be managed by the program director Vedran Mimica, M.S.Arch advising faculty and M.S.Arch studio instructors will be actively participating in implementation.